

נח

Mega Bible
parasha sheet
theothermatthewmiller.com



Noach

Genesis 6:9–11:32 — the flood, the ark, the covenant of the rainbow, Babel, and ten generations to Abram

THE PARASHA BY THE NUMBERS

153

VERSES

1862

WORDS

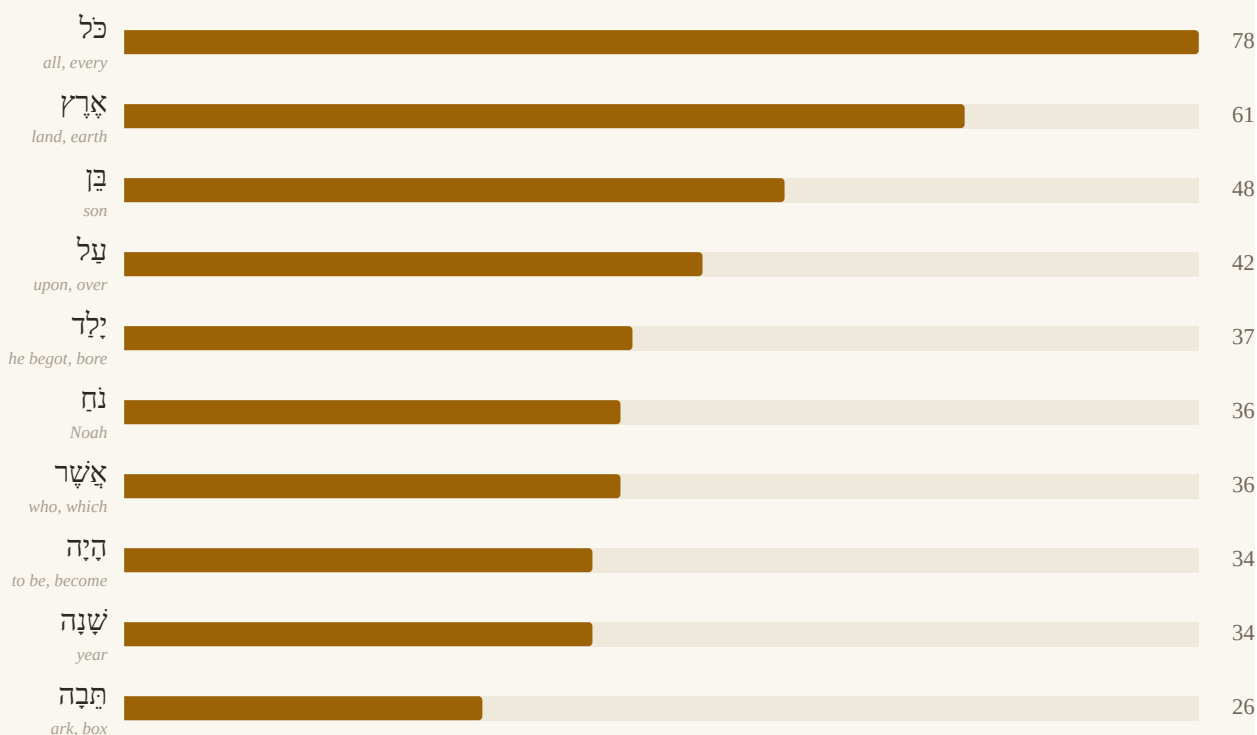
410

DISTINCT ROOTS

13

HAPAX LEGOMENA

MOST FREQUENT ROOTS



Averaging **12.2 words** a verse. The longest verse is **8:21** at 32 words — God's own resolve never again to curse the earth because of humanity, reasoning through the very impulse that caused the flood; the shortest, **8:15**, has only 5 — the bare formula introducing what God says next.

WHAT THE PARASHA CALLS GOD



אֱלֹהִים (Elohim) narrowly outnumbers ה' across the parasha — the same two-name interplay as Bereshit, din (judgment: the decision to flood) and rachamim (mercy: the decision, after, never to again) trading the story back and forth.

THIRTEEN WORDS THAT OCCUR NOWHERE ELSE IN THE BIBLE

6:14	גִּפְרִי	גִּפְרִי	H1613
gopher-wood — of unknown species, used nowhere else			
8:11	טֶרֶף		H2965
freshly plucked (the olive leaf)			
8:22	קָרָא	קָרָא	H7120
cold			
10:10	אֶרֶךְ	אֶרֶךְ	H751
Erech (Uruk), a city of Nimrod's kingdom			
10:10	אֶכַד	אֶכַד	H390
Accad (Akkad), a city of Nimrod's kingdom			
10:12	רֶסֶן		H7449
Resen, a city between Nineveh and Calah			
10:19	לֶשֶׁעַ	לֶשֶׁעַ	H3962
Lesha, a border-town of the Canaanites			
10:23	מָשׁ	מָשׁ	H4851
Mash, a son of Aram			
10:28	עוֹבָל		H5745
Obal, a son of Joktan			
10:30	מִיֶּלֶשָׁא	מִיֶּלֶשָׁא	H4852
Mesha, a boundary-point of Joktan's territory			
10:30	סְפָרָה	סְפָרָה	H5611
Sephar, a mountain marking that territory's edge			
11:29	יִסְכָּה		H3252
Jiskah, Abram's niece			
11:30	וֶלֶד		H2056
child, offspring			

Hapax legomena, counted against the whole Tanakh: thirteen of this parasha's 410 roots are used exactly once in all of Scripture, and 199 more appear only once here. Nine of the thirteen are place- or personal names buried in the Table of Nations — the parasha's rarest vocabulary isn't the flood at all, but the roll call of everyone the flood's survivors became.

6:14 תִּבְיָה

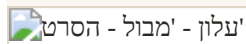
the vessel that carries Noah's family through catastrophe becomes the ordinary word for any sealed container

עָשָׂה לֶךְ תִּבְיָה — the word for Noah's vessel, תִּבְיָה, was never a specialized nautical term; the very same word names the little basket of reeds and pitch that carries the infant Moses down the Nile (Exodus 2:3). In Modern Hebrew it has stayed exactly that ordinary: a תִּבְיָה is any enclosed box or case — a mailbox is a תִּיבַת דּוֹאֵר, a music box a תִּיבַת נְגִינָה, an email inbox a תִּיבַת נְכֵס. The specific idiom תִּיבַת נֹחַ keeps Noah's version alive on its own terms, though: Israelis use it for any space crammed with every conceivable kind of person or thing thrown together at once — a packed commuter train, a chaotic moving day, a fractious coalition government are all, affectionately or not, called a תִּיבַת נֹחַ.

11:9 בָּלַל

the verb for God's confusion of languages at Babel gives Modern Hebrew its ordinary word for confusion itself

עַל־כֵּן קָרָא שְׁמָהּ בָּבֶל כִּי־שָׁם בָּלַל ה' שִׁפְתֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ — the text supplies its own etymology: Babel (בָּבֶל) is named for the verb בָּלַל, "to confuse, to mix up." Modern Hebrew took the root and ran with it: בָּלַל means to confuse someone, and the noun בְּלִבּוֹל — built straight off the Biblical root — is the everyday word for confusion or a mix-up, with none of the original's theological weight left: a בְּלִבּוֹל can be a scheduling mix-up, a mental fog, or a toddler's tantrum. The Hungarian psychoanalyst Sándor Ferenczi's landmark 1933 paper on childhood trauma was published in Hebrew translation under exactly this word — בְּלִבּוֹל הַשְּׁפוּת בֵּין הַמְּבוגֵרִים לִילֵד ("Confusion of Tongues Between the Adult and the Child"), held today in the National Library's catalogue — extending Babel's own confusion of tongues into a clinical term for a child mistaking an adult's language of desire for the language of tenderness.



Suzanne Dellal Centre for Dance and Theatre Archive / Batsheva Dance Company, National Library of Israel, 1993
FL58235059

6:17 מַבּוּל

the word for Noah's own catastrophe becomes Modern Hebrew's ordinary word for any overwhelming deluge

מַבּוּל appears in the Torah nowhere outside Noah's own story (it returns only once more, in Psalms 29:10, remembering it). In Modern Hebrew it is entirely unremarkable: a מַבּוּל is any overwhelming flood — a מַבּוּל של תְּגוּבוֹת ("a flood of responses"), a מַבּוּל של תּוּרִיסִים ("a flood of tourists"), a מַבּוּל של מֵידַע ("an information deluge") — the word keeping its sense of being overwhelmed all at once while shedding its cosmic scale. In 1993 the Suzanne Dellal Centre for Dance and Theatre programmed a screening of the הסרט — מַבּוּל ("The Flood — the Movie"), Ram Baruch's film of Ohad Naharin's own dance piece מַבּוּל; the surviving festival flyer, preserved in the National Library's dance archive, uses the word exactly as Genesis does — total, engulfing, and needing no further explanation.

ATTESTED · NATIONAL LIBRARY OF ISRAEL · 1993

עלון - 'מבול' - הסרט

Festival flyer for Ram Baruch's film of Ohad Naharin's dance piece "Mabul" (The Flood), screened at the Suzanne Dellal Centre, May 1993.

EIGHT NARRATIVE UNITS, BY WORD COUNT

עוֹת וְהַחֲלָטָה Corruption & the decision 189 words	טַעֲנִית הַתִּבְיָה Loading the ark 227 words	הַמַּבּוּל The flood 297 words	הַבְּרִית וְהַקֶּשֶׁת Covenant & rainbow 349 words	שִׁכְרוֹת נֹחַ Noah's drunkenness 121 words	טַבַּלַּת הָעַמִּים Table of Nations 287 words	מִגְדַּל בָּבֶל Tower of Babel 121 words	מִשֵּׁם עַד אַבְרָם Shem to Abram 271 words
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The covenant and the rainbow run longer than any other unit — the story pausing to spell out its own moral before moving on. The Tower of Babel is tied for the shortest unit in the whole parasha, exactly matching Noah's drunkenness: nine verses is all it takes to scatter the entire human race across the earth, despite being the parasha's most famous story after the flood itself.

MY NOTES

Nothing recorded yet — the notes field is empty for every verse of Genesis 6:9–11:32.

